

Kdenlive

Kdenlive is free and open source professional video editing software made by KDE, the team behind the legendary KDE Plasma, KDE Neon desktop environments alongside a plethora of other linux software oriented for productivity.

Starting off

1. Create a new folder and name it (for example – VIDEO EDIT)
2. Put all your images and audio inside this VIDEO EDIT folder
3. Go to: Applications > Sound and video > KdenliveFile > save as > and then select the folder VIDEO EDIT
4. give a name to the project (lets say – My first edit),click on save.
5. Double click inside the Project tree window on the top left
6. In the pop up window that opens,go to your VIDEO EDIT folder,select all the images and audio that you want to import into the project, click on Open

Now all the images that you need for the video edit are imported into your project, You're all set to start the edit.

Getting things done

1. Simply drag and drop the images from the project tree, onto any of the video tracks on the timeline.
2. Click on the image you want to move on the video track and simply hold the click and move left or right to move the image.
3. Use Space to play or pause. You can also click on play or pause buttons on the monitor window.
4. To extend the image, take the cursor to the right end of the clip on the track > a green triangle flashes and the cursor shape changes to a right arrow > hold click and drag to the right to extend your image/ clip OR even decrease the length of your image/ clip by pulling to the left.

MOVE your clips around, EXTEND or DECREASE the length of your image/ clips as you need them.

These are the only basic tools you need to make your video!

For Video

To move/ push many clips together, to the right: select the Spacer tool from the tool bar at the bottom.

To Split a clip:

On the timeline, play the clip you want to edit pause the clip where you want to cut it, select the Razor tool from the tool bar at the bottom click on the clip where the cursor has paused, the clip splits.

To delete a part of the clip:

split the clip and then either:

- a) split the clip again at the point where you want to remove the clip and click on the clip that has now been formed and simply press the Del button on your keyboard OR
- b) take the cursor to the left end of the split clip, hold click and pull to the right to eliminate the part of the clip that you don't want.

These tools above are the ones you'll need mostly when you're working with video clips.

Enhancements

To make your video appear clean, smooth and more attractive, there are two main tools:

- a) Effects
- b) Transition

1. **Effects** as the name suggests – is a tool that allows you to enhance your clips – change the brightness, make them look like old film footage, crop it, scale it and so on.

2. **Transition** on the other hand is the tool that allows you different ways of changing from one clip to the other. So this is not for one single clip but between two clips that are next to each other.

Effects

To add a video effect:

Click on the clip that you want to add an effect to and then either:

- a) right click on the clip and go to > video effect > choose the effect that you want to add (for example: sepia) OR
- b) In the effects window, choose the effect you want to add and double click on this effect. (for example: go to Effects list > Colour > Sepia – double click)

Your clip now has the Sepia effect added to it = your clip colour has changed to Sepia

To delete an effect:

Click on the clip whose effect you want to delete, the effect stack window will automatically open at the top left. The effect/s that you have added will show up there. click on the effect you want to delete (for example Sepia) and then:

- a) Click on the delete button (the cross icon in red) at the bottom of the effect stack window OR

- b) Click on the tick box next to the effect in the effect stack – this removes the effect from the clip but keeps the effect there in case you change your mind and want to use the effect.

Simply click the tick in the box again to add the effect back.

To add an Audio effect:

Click on the audio clip that you want to add an effect to and then either:

- a) right click on the clip and go to > audio effect > choose the effect that you want to add (for example: Reverb) OR
- b) In the effects window, choose the effect you want to add and double click on this effect. (for example: go to Effects list > Audio > Reverb – double click)

Your clip now has the Reverb effect added to it = your audio clip has a slight echo!

To delete the audio effect:

Same as deleting the video effect.

Transition

To add a transition between two clips:

1. Identify the two clips next to each other that you want to add a transition to
2. Keep the first of these two clips on one track (say track 1)
3. Simply hold click on the second clip and pull it down to the track below (track 2)
4. Move the second clip slightly to the left so that the two clips overlap.
5. Now right click on the first clip and go to > Add Transition > Dissolve (for example) a small box appears between the two clips – that's your transition
6. Now your first clip dissolves into the second!

To delete a transition between two clips:

1. Click on the transition box that has appeared between the two clips
2. Press delete on your keyboard

Your transition is gone

Have fun exploring

Titling

1. To add a title to your project:

Method 1

Go to Project > Add Title Clip

Method 2

Go to the Project tree window

Scroll down to the bottom

Right click in the empty space at the bottom of the project tree window

Click on [Add Title Clip](#)

A title window pops up

Here you can type in the text that you want, change the text font, size, colour and position.

Once you're done, click on the [Save](#) as icon on tool bar on the top left, give your title a name.

Make sure you're saving the title in the same folder where your project and your images are saved.

Click on [Save](#)

Click on [Ok](#)

Your title is now added to your [Project tree](#).

Click on the title in the Project tree, hold click, drag and drop it into the timeline.

Move your title clip to where ever you want to place it.

Exporting your final video

Once you're finished with the edit and want to have the full video on your hands – ready for sharing, first:

1. Play the entire video from start to finish and make sure everything is ok
2. Click on the green bar in the timeline and extend it to cover your complete edit
3. Now click on [Render](#) button
4. Click on the [Render Project](#) tab
5. Choose your Destination as: File rendering
6. Click in the Output file bar and choose where you want to save your final video
7. Select AV DV on the left and DV Pal 4:3 on the right (or widescreen if your video is shot in widescreen)
8. Make sure Export Audio is ticked
9. Set Scanning to Auto
10. Select Selected Zone

Click on [Render to file](#).

Your render job will start.

Wait for it to complete

When it says 100%, your video is ready to serve